

The king cannot enter attack

Foundations

THE IDEA

The king moves one square in any direction but may never move into check. You also cannot make another move that leaves your king attacked. This restriction overrides material gain, attacking ideas, and ordinary piece mobility.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If a rook shields its king from an enemy rook on the same file, moving that rook sideways may expose check. The sideways move is illegal unless it also captures or blocks the checking line in another way.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Can you capture the enemy king to finish a game?

ANSWER AND REASONING

No. Checkmate ends the game before a king could be captured. A legal position never permits a move that leaves your own king in check.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Legality comes before evaluation.